



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Calvary Chapel Academy
School Website: <https://calvaryec.com/cca>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because ACCS require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Calvary Chapel Academy (Columbia, MD, 20145) presents a theology-forward, biblically grounded model positioned as a Classical Christian school within the Calvary Chapel ecosystem. Public-facing materials emphasize discipleship, biblical worldview formation, and community-partnered education, framing the school as an education ministry that aims to form character and faith alongside academic growth. However, the site does not clearly articulate the core liberal-arts curriculum (e.g., Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or a historically integrated curriculum) or the classic pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, scholé rhythms, or explicit memory/recitation practices) that typify a full Classical curriculum in the canonical sense described by classical-education lexicons. Consequently, the school demonstrates a strong classical-inflected religious formation but only partial alignment with the six-element classical rubric.

Overall classification by category:

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): CLASSICAL
- Element 3 (Curriculum): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 (Faculty): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): CLASSICAL

Aggregate: NOT CLASSICAL

Key insights:

- The school exhibits robust theological grounding and a clearly stated formation goal centered on discipleship and biblical worldview, meeting core aspects of Classical aims in spirit if not in the full liberal-arts articulation. Evidence: explicit mission language, Abide/Equip/Contend framework, and partnership with families in spiritual formation.
- Curriculum articulation is the primary area of mismatch with classical criteria; there is limited public evidence of Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, or sustained history-integration across disciplines.
- Pedagogy and faculty descriptions on the site lean toward mentoring, discipleship, and ministry partnerships rather than explicit Socratic/Scholé practices, living-curriculum modeling, or teacher-virtue portraits typical of classical programs.
- The Parents & Community dimension shows clear partnership with families as co-educators and active parental involvement, aligning with classical-community expectations.

What would move the needle

- Publicly articulate and implement a full Seven Liberal Arts-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) and explicit Great Books/Great Conversation components,

with history threaded throughout the curriculum. Reference: classical lexicon emphasizes Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, and integrated history as core cues of classical formation.

- Adopt and communicate explicit classic-pedagogy practices (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning rhythms, memory work/recitation, and opportunities for high-school rhetoric and public speaking). Evidence from the classical canon shows these pedagogies as hallmarks of classical schools.
- Strengthen the living-curriculum concept by featuring teacher-portrait standards and faculty-mentorship models as part of the school's public materials, aligning with the classical expectation of teachers as virtuous exemplars.
- Deepen explicit integration of liturgical/community practices in daily pedagogy (worship/morning prayer, sacred calendar, liturgical rhythm) to meet the liturgical/communal facet of the classical rubric.

ABSTRACT

Calvary Chapel Academy (Columbia, MD, 20145) demonstrates a strong religious-metaphysical orientation and explicit formation goals aligned with classical aims in spirit (theology-informed mission, biblical worldview, and family partnerships) but shows limited public articulation of the full classical curriculum and pedagogy (Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Socratic/Scholé practices). The net assessment places the school as NOT CLASSICAL overall, with Element 2 and Element 6 leaning CLASSICAL, Element 1 SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, and Categories 3–5 NOT CLASSICAL. Strengthening the explicit liberal-arts curriculum, classical teaching methods, and teacher-formation materials would raise the overall alignment toward CLASSICAL.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents a robust theological framing: “partner with families to disciple students in the knowledge of God through Jesus Christ, developing a Biblical worldview that produces spiritual excellence.” This clearly signals theological grounding and transcendent aims.
- The Abide/Equip/Contend framing anchors virtue formation and scriptural instruction, citing biblical verses as foundational to education (John 15:4; 2 Timothy 3:16-17). This aligns with Grounded in Theology and elements of transcendental moral realism in practice.
- Category language in the site emphasizes discipleship and biblical instruction, which supports a theologically anchored education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators from classical lexicon: theology, sacred scripture, biblical worldview, virtue (implied by discipleship), moral formation, Logos (if interpreted via “Word of God”) and divine order are present in spirit. The explicit terms from the school site include “Biblical worldview,” “Word of God,” and “discipleship.”
- Negative indicators: None of the explicit secular-education negations (e.g., values-neutral, secular ethics) appear; however, explicit liturgical and communal practices as defined by the classical model are not clearly articulated in the public materials.

Why this rating

- The school's religious foundations are strong and formative, but the absence of clearly stated liturgical practices and the lack of explicit Great Books/Seven Liberal Arts content tempers the category to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL. The core formation emphasis is aligned with classical aims, but the full shape of a classical curriculum/ pedagogy is not fully demonstrated in public materials.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission centers on forming students through a Biblical worldview and spiritual excellence, indicating that formation and virtue are core goals rather than mere information processing. The explicit phrasing around discipling students and developing a biblical worldview signals formation-focused aims.
- The language around Abide/Equip/Contend frames a telos oriented toward character formation, faith formation, and enduring truths, consistent with formation-centered classical aims.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: formation, virtue, human flourishing, classical mission, great conversation (implied through “classical” label and discipleship) are present in the lexicon (Great Books/Great Conversation are not explicitly named on the site, but formation and telos align with the classical mission). The public materials emphasize formation and a classical-leaning mission.
- Negative indicators: None of the explicit “workforce preparation” or 21st-century job-readiness language is foregrounded; instead, formation is foregrounded. This supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating

- The school clearly prioritizes formation and virtue over instrumental job-readiness, consistent with classical aims for education as paideia. The emphasis on discipleship and biblical worldview supports a CLASSICAL rating for this category.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials describe the school as offering Classical Christian Education but do not publicly articulate the core liberal-arts curriculum (Trivium/Quadrivium) or Great Books/Great Conversation components. The explicit mention of “Classical Christian Education” is present, yet there is no explicit, published curriculum map referencing Trivium, Quadrivium, or Great Books within the public materials reviewed.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators (from the classical lexicon): Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books, Great Conversation, and an integrated history approach. The school’s public materials do not demonstrate these items directly; the absence of such explicit curricular markers yields a negative signal for this category.
- Negative indicators: The absence of explicit Trivium/Quadrivium, Great Books, and explicit ‘Great Conversation’ language in the school’s public materials is a negative signal for Element 3. The lexicon clearly flags these elements as essential to a classical curriculum.

Why this rating

- Because the site does not publicly present the Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or an integrated Trivium/Quadrivium approach across disciplines, Element 3 is NOT CLASSICAL, even though the school identifies as Classical Christian Education.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize discipleship, mentoring, and partnership models (e.g., Classroom Mentor, Academic Mentor, Family Mentor) but do not publicly present the classical pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars, scholé/restful learning rhythms, memorization/recitation, or explicit rhetoric training) that characterize a classical pedagogy.

- The explicit presence of a “four days on campus, one day on home” structure hints at a rest-focused cadence, but there is no explicit articulation of Scholé as a deliberate learning rhythm or of Socratic dialogue across grades. The Great Books/Socratic rhetoric ecosystem is not publicly described.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators (from the classical lexicon): Socratic seminar, recitation, chanting, scholé, memory work, rhetoric exercises, debate, and upper-school oratory are listed as classical pedagogical markers. These are not visibly foregrounded in the school’s public materials.
- Negative indicators: The public materials describe mentoring and discipleship rather than classic Socratic seminars or formal memory/recitation practices. This signals a lack of the core classical pedagogy in public-facing materials.

Why this rating

- The absence of explicit classical pedagogical practices in the public materials supports NOT CLASSICAL for Element 4. The school emphasizes formation and mentoring rather than the signature classical teaching methods.

Element 5: School Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Materials describe faculty in terms of mentoring and partnership with families, rather than a traditional classical-faculty portrait (e.g., “living curriculum,” “portrait of a teacher,” “faculty of friends,” etc.). The site indicates roles like Classroom Mentor and Academic Mentor rather than living-curriculum modeling by teachers themselves.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: The classical lexicon envisions teachers as models of virtue, mentors, and the living curriculum. The school does include mentors and collaborative roles, but the public materials do not present a robust “teacher-as-virtue-model” portrait or a formal “portrait of a teacher” standard.
- Negative indicators: The absence of explicit language about teachers as virtuous exemplars, “portrait of what a teacher should be,” or a faculty-culture oriented toward living curriculum signals a weaker alignment with Element 5.

Why this rating

- Given the public-facing materials, Element 5 does not clearly meet the classical faculty criteria and is best characterized as NOT CLASSICAL. The school emphasizes mentors within partnership structures rather than a fully articulated classical-faculty paradigm.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- There is explicit emphasis on partnering with families and treating parents as co-teachers in the educational process; roles such as Family Mentor, Classroom Mentor, and Academic Mentor are described, along with a stated aim to involve congregational support and parental formation. This aligns with the classical-community expectation of parental partnership and formation.
- The mission materials explicitly call for partnering with families to disciple students in a Biblical worldview and to integrate church/congregation resources into school life; this demonstrates a robust parent-community dimension.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators: Partnership with families; parent formation; open campus/visits; parent engagement; home-school alignment; family catechesis; parental leadership (as part of the program). The Six Elements lexicon lists these positive markers under “Partnership with Families” and “Formation of

Affections” as core components of classical parents/community. The school materials show explicit alignment with this model.

- Negative indicators: None evident in the public materials; no viral “customer” stance; rather, active involvement and formation of families are described.

Why this rating

- The public materials clearly reflect a strong, purposeful partnership with parents and community engagement, consistent with CLASSICAL in this category.
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What Would Move the Needle

- Publicly map and publish a full liberal-arts curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric; arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy) and demonstrate how Great Books, primary sources, and Western canon are integrated across grades, along with explicit interdisciplinary connections. This would move Element 3 from NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
 - Adopt and publicize explicit classical pedagogy: regular Socratic seminars, Scholé rhythms, memorization/recitation, and opportunities for student rhetoric and debate in upper grades. This would move Element 4 toward CLASSICAL.
 - Expand the “living curriculum” language for faculty, explicitly presenting teacher portraits, mentorship models, and faculty formation programs in public materials. This would move Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.
 - Amplify liturgical and communal practices as explicit, regular elements of daily pedagogy (daily or weekly chapel, liturgy-informed rhythms, sacred music) to strengthen Element 1.
 - Maintain and deepen the parental-partnership model with formal parent-education offerings (book studies, workshops) to reinforce Element 6 further and ensure sustained co-formation of students.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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